SENTIMENT ANALYSIS OF SOCIAL MEDIA MENTIONS

Gamage Recruiters (Pvt) Ltd

Platform	LinkedIn
Focus Area	Recruitment & HR / Branding Analytics
Period	February 2025 — March 2026
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Duration	3 Weeks

1. Executive Summary

This report presents the findings of a sentiment analysis conducted on LinkedIn social media mentions of Gamage Recruiters (Pvt) Ltd. The analysis was performed as part of a Data Science internship project with the objective of understanding public perception of the company on LinkedIn and providing actionable insights to the HR, recruitment, and marketing teams.

A total of 112 LinkedIn posts were collected manually between January 2025 and February 2026. Of these, 21 posts contained public comment text and were selected for sentiment analysis. Two industry-standard NLP tools; VADER and TextBlob, were applied to classify each comment as Positive, Neutral, or Negative.

Key Finding: 90.5% of all public comments analyzed were classified as Positive, with 9.5% Neutral and 0% Negative. Both VADER and TextBlob achieved 100% agreement across all 21 comments, indicating high confidence in the results.

2. Objective and Scope

2.1 Objective

The primary objective of this project was to determine whether social media mentions of Gamage Recruiters on LinkedIn carry a positive, negative, or neutral sentiment. This helps the company understand how its brand and recruitment activities are perceived by its LinkedIn audience, and supports evidence-based decision making for HR, marketing, and recruitment strategy.

2.2 Scope

- **Platform analyzed:** LinkedIn only
- **Data collection period:** January 2025 to February 2026
- **Total posts collected:** 112
- **Posts with public comments (analyzed):** 21
- **Posts without comments (excluded from sentiment analysis):** 90
- **Language:** English (8 Sinhala-language posts were identified and excluded from NLP analysis as VADER and TextBlob are English-only tools)

Scope Limitation: This analysis covers only LinkedIn. A more comprehensive future study should include Facebook, Instagram, and Glassdoor to capture a broader picture of public perception.

3. Data Sources and Collection Method

3.1 Platform and Source

Data was collected manually from the official Gamage Recruiters LinkedIn company page and associated posts by company employees. LinkedIn was selected as the primary platform because it is the most relevant social media channel for a recruitment company, where job seekers, employers, and professionals actively discuss career and hiring-related topics.

3.2 Collection Method

Data was collected through manual scraping, posts and comments were reviewed on LinkedIn and entered into a structured Microsoft Excel spreadsheet. The following data fields were recorded for each entry:

- **Mention ID** — unique identifier for each row
- **Platform** — LinkedIn
- **Date** — date of the post
- **Author** — name of the post author where available
- **Caption of the Post** — full text of the post written by the company or individual
- **Comment Text** — text of public comments left by LinkedIn users
- **Engagement Metrics** — number of likes, shares, and comments
- **Post URL** — direct link to the original post
- **Type of Post** — categorized as Marketing Post or Job Post

3.3 Dataset Overview

Metric	Value
Total rows collected	112
Marketing Posts	64
Job Posts	48
Posts with public comments	21 (18.8%)
Posts with no comments	90 (81.2%)
English posts	103
Sinhala posts (excluded)	8
Date range	Last Week of February 2025 — Second Week of March 2026

4. Sentiment Analysis Methodology

4.1 Tools Used

Two Python-based NLP libraries were used to perform sentiment analysis:

Tool	Full Name	Best For	Role
VADER	Valence Aware Dictionary and sEntiment Reasoner	Social media text	**Primary**
TextBlob	General-purpose NLP library	General text	Secondary / Validation

4.2 Why VADER Was Chosen as the Primary Method

VADER was selected as the primary tool because it was specifically designed and trained on social media content. It handles short informal phrases, capitalization differences, and punctuation emphasis, all of which are common in LinkedIn comments. TextBlob was used as a secondary validation tool. Where both methods agreed, the result was classified as High Confidence.

4.3 Classification Rules

Sentiment	VADER Threshold	TextBlob Threshold
Positive	Compound score >= 0.05	Polarity > 0
Neutral	Between -0.05 and 0.05	Polarity = 0
Negative	Compound score <= -0.05	Polarity < 0

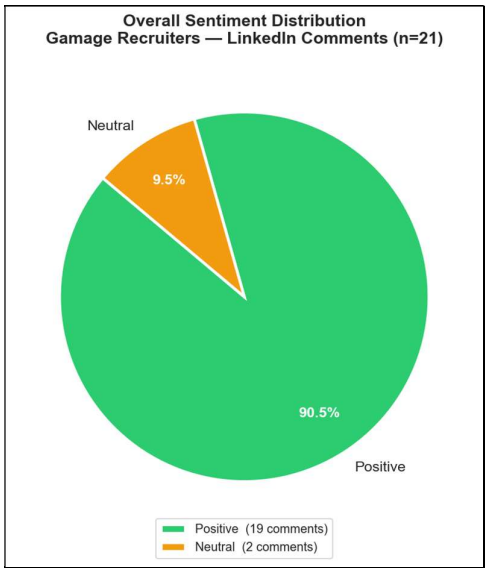
4.4 Decision Rule for Final Label

- If VADER and TextBlob both give the same label — that label is used with High Confidence
- If VADER and TextBlob disagree — VADER's label is used with Low Confidence
- **Result:** All 21 comments achieved High Confidence (100% agreement between both methods)

5. Key Results

5.1 Overall Sentiment Distribution

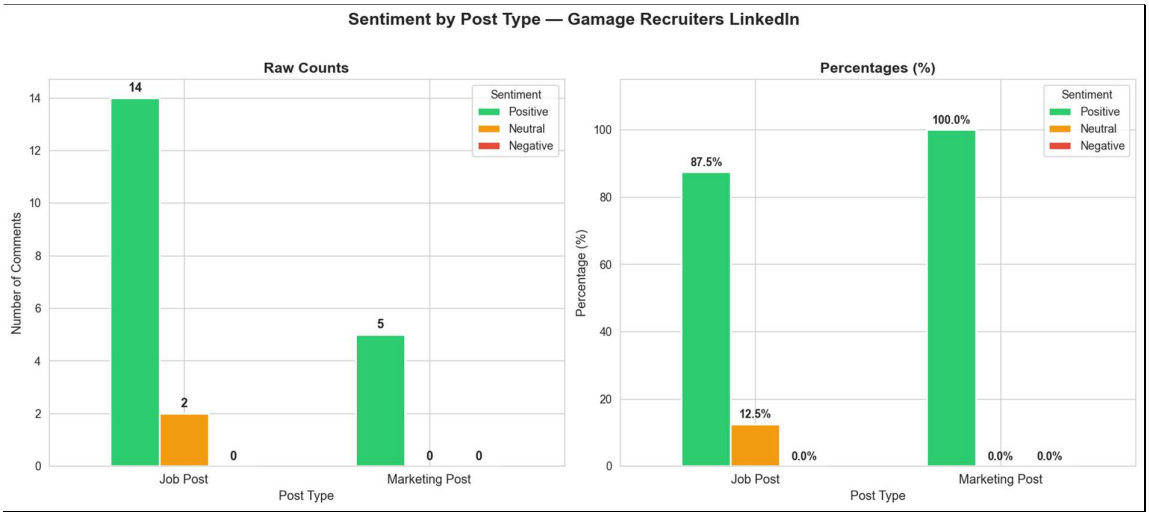
Sentiment	Count	Percentage	Confidence
Positive	19	90.5%	High (100%)
Neutral	2	9.5%	High (100%)
Negative	0	0.0%	N/A
Total	**21**	**100%**	**—**



Note: The two Neutral results correspond to LI-087 ("What is the industry" — a genuine question with no sentiment) and LI-095 ("CFBR" — a generic algorithmic engagement phrase).

5.2 Sentiment by Post Type

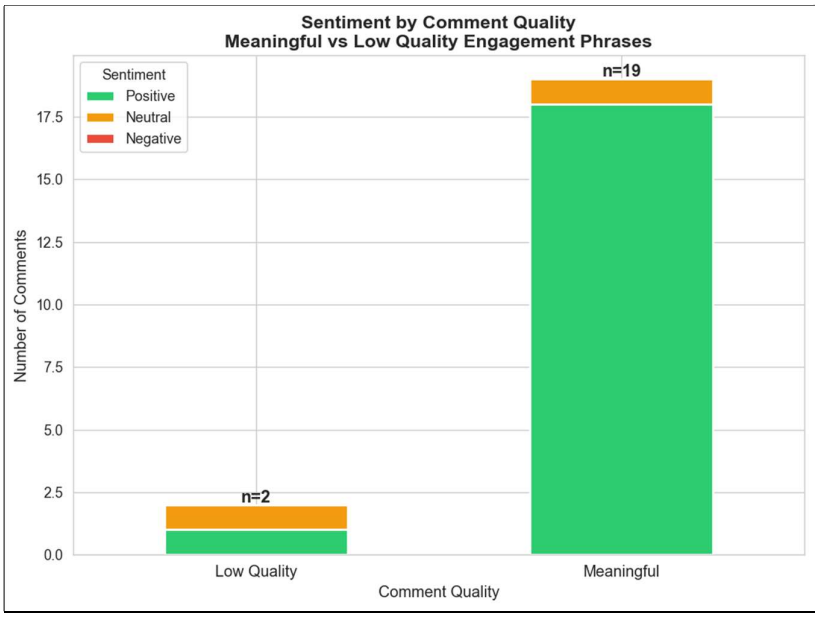
Post Type	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Total	% Positive
Job Post	14	2	0	16	**87.5%**
Marketing Post	5	0	0	5	**100.0%**



5.3 Comment Quality Analysis

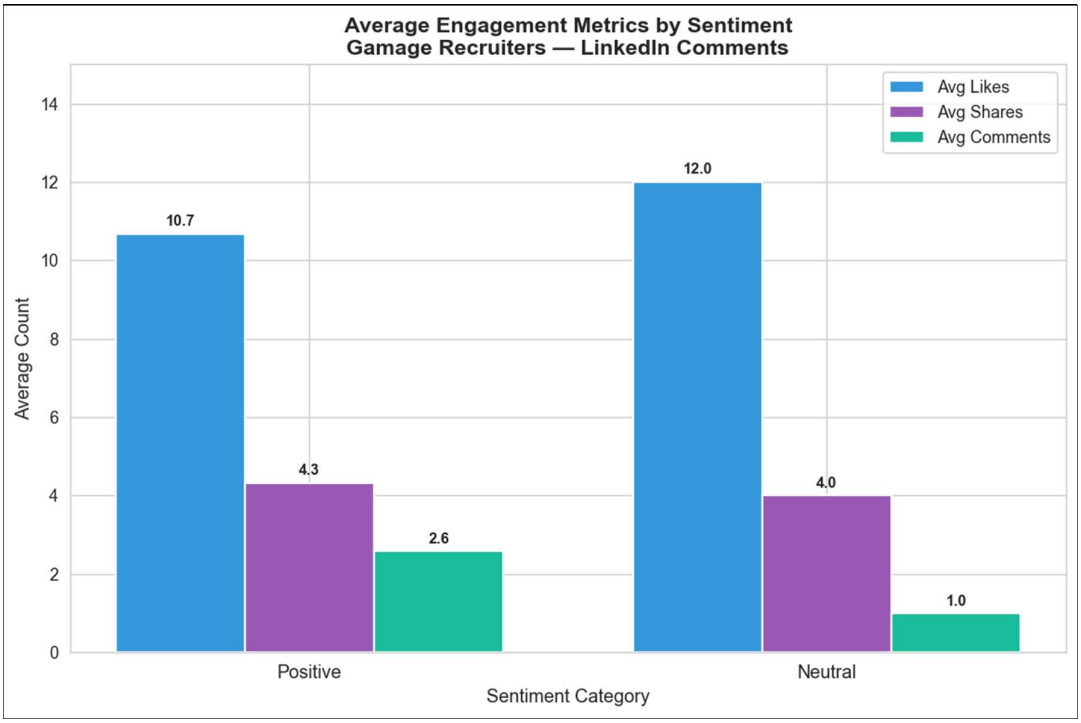
During analysis, comments were assessed for meaningful sentiment content versus generic LinkedIn engagement phrases (such as CFBR — Comment For Better Reach, and repetitive filler phrases).

Comment Category	Count	Positive	Neutral
Meaningful comments	19	18	1
Low quality / generic phrases	2	1	1



5.4 Engagement Metrics by Sentiment

Sentiment	Avg Likes	Avg Shares	Avg Comments
Positive	10.68	4.32	2.58
Neutral	12.00	4.00	1.00



6. Key Insights

Insight 1 — Overwhelmingly Positive Public Sentiment

- 90.5% of all public LinkedIn comments were classified as Positive with 100% confidence. No negative comments were recorded during the entire data collection period. This indicates that Gamage Recruiters' LinkedIn audience responds favorably to the company's content and does not express public dissatisfaction on this platform.

Insight 2 — Marketing Posts Achieve 100% Positive Sentiment

- All five Marketing Post comments were classified as Positive. Comments such as "Looks great", "This is great", "Love this" and "I'm interested" demonstrate that the company's brand messaging, positioning itself as a career partner and HR solutions provider, resonates positively with its audience. The phrase "I'm interested" (LI-108) is particularly notable as it represents a marketing post converting into active candidate interest.

Insight 3 — Job Posts Generate the Most Engagement but Include a Clarity Gap

- 16 of the 21 commented posts were Job Posts. The only genuinely informative question in the entire dataset came from a Job Post: LI-087 where a user asked "What is the industry" on a multi-position hiring post. This indicates that at least some job posts lack sufficient industry or context information for candidates to self-qualify, which can increase recruiter workload and reduce application quality.

Insight 4 — Low Overall Audience Engagement is the Most Significant Finding

- 81.2% of all collected posts received zero public comments. Posts that did receive comments averaged only 2 to 3 responses each. This is the most actionable finding in the report. While existing sentiment is positive, the volume of public engagement is very low for a recruitment company's LinkedIn page, suggesting that the audience size, content strategy, or posting frequency needs improvement.

Insight 5 — Weekly Hiring Bulletin Posts Generate the Most Comments

- The posts generating the highest comment counts (3 to 5 comments each) consistently followed the weekly hiring bulletin format, consolidating multiple job opportunities into a single post. Individual single-job posts generated fewer responses. This suggests the audience prefers curated content over individual listings.

Insight 6 — CFBR Comments Indicate Algorithmic Rather Than Genuine Engagement

- Two comments were identified as CFBR (Comment For Better Reach) responses — a LinkedIn tactic where users comment to boost algorithmic visibility rather than express genuine sentiment. While these comments are not harmful, they should not be interpreted as genuine audience interest or brand endorsement.

7. Recommendations

7.1 For the Recruitment Team

- Include the industry name and company type clearly in every job post caption. At least one public user asked for this information (LI-087), and many others may have disengaged silently for the same reason.
- Standardize the weekly hiring bulletin format and publish it consistently on the same day each week. This format generates the highest comment volumes and likely performs better with LinkedIn's algorithm.
- Consider adding a direct question at the end of each job post such as "**Does this role interest you?**" to encourage more genuine comment engagement.

7.2 For the Marketing Team

- Continue producing career partnership and HR solutions content, as all Marketing Post comments were 100% Positive. This content style is working well.
- Track "**I'm interested**" style comments and follow up with those users directly, as they represent warm leads already expressing interest.
- Introduce a consistent posting schedule and experiment with LinkedIn polls and interactive formats to drive audience growth and improve engagement rates.

7.3 For the HR and Branding Teams

- Grow the LinkedIn follower base as a priority. Low engagement is partly a function of a small audience. A follower growth strategy through employee advocacy, partnerships, or targeted LinkedIn campaigns would increase the volume of organic comments in future analyses.

- Encourage employees and placed candidates to share authentic experiences on LinkedIn. First-person testimonials generate significantly higher engagement than company-authored content alone.
- Expand data collection to other social media platforms for a more complete picture of public perception. LinkedIn shows only one dimension of brand sentiment.

7.4 Priority Summary

Recommendation	Target Team	Priority
Include industry name in every job post	Recruitment	**High**
Standardize weekly hiring bulletin format	Recruitment	**High**
Grow LinkedIn follower base	HR & Branding	**High**
Continue marketing partnership content	Marketing	**Medium**
Reply to every comment received	Marketing	**Medium**
Follow up on I'm interested comments	Recruitment & Marketing	**Medium**
Expand to other social media platforms	HR & Branding	**Low**

8. Limitations

The following limitations should be considered when interpreting the findings of this report:

- **Small sample size:** Only 21 comments were available for sentiment analysis out of 112 total posts collected. This limits the statistical reliability of percentage-based conclusions.
- **Single platform:** Data was collected from LinkedIn only. Public perception on other platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, and Glassdoor is not captured in this analysis.
- **Generic comment language:** The majority of comments consisted of short, generic phrases such as "Great opportunity" and "Exciting opportunity". While these are genuinely positive, they provide limited depth for nuanced insight extraction.
- **English-only analysis:** 8 Sinhala-language posts were excluded from NLP analysis as VADER and TextBlob do not support Sinhala. These posts may carry different sentiment patterns from the Sinhala-speaking audience segment.
- **No negative data found:** The absence of negative comments does not necessarily confirm universal satisfaction. Dissatisfied users may simply choose not to comment on LinkedIn.
- **Manual data collection:** Manual scraping introduces potential for human error in transcription and may not capture all available comments, particularly on older posts.

9. Conclusion

This sentiment analysis of Gamage Recruiters' LinkedIn presence reveals a consistently positive public perception. The company's content, both job postings and marketing material generates no measurable negative sentiment from its LinkedIn audience. The 90.5% positive sentiment rate, supported by 100% agreement between two independent NLP tools, provides a reliable baseline measure of brand health on LinkedIn.

However, the most significant finding is not the sentiment itself but the volume of engagement. With 81.2% of posts receiving no public comments, the company has an important opportunity to grow its LinkedIn audience and deepen the quality of interactions it receives. Implementing the recommendations in this report, particularly standardizing the weekly hiring bulletin format, clarifying job post details, and pursuing a follower growth strategy would meaningfully improve both the quantity and quality of public engagement in future periods.

Overall Assessment: Gamage Recruiters maintains a positive brand image on LinkedIn. The immediate priority should be increasing audience engagement volume rather than managing negative sentiment, as no negative sentiment was detected during the analysis period.

END OF THE REPORT